

YORK COUNTY COMMUNITY COLLEGE

ADJUNCT FACULTY HANDBOOK



2025/2026

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Welcome to York County Community College

Welcome to York County Community College! I am so glad that you have chosen to be part of our team of dedicated faculty and staff. The experience, expertise, and passion our adjunct faculty bring to the classroom is invaluable to our students and academic programs.

This handbook, along with the new instructor orientation resources, is designed to help familiarize you with the college and provide valuable information about teaching at YCCC. Please take some time to review the processes and policies in this handbook. However, these resources are only a guide, and I encourage you to ask any member of the faculty, staff, or administration any questions as you begin your semester.

Thank you for helping our students reach their goals. I wish you success at YCCC and hope that you find the work satisfying and rewarding.

Sincerely,

Anne Crampton
Dean of Education

YCCC's 'MVP'

Mission: To develop an educated, skilled, and adaptable workforce. Our mission guides our curriculum development and pedagogical approaches, ensuring educational excellence and that every student is prepared not only for career success but also for meaningful engagement in society.

Vision: To drive socioeconomic mobility for our students; transforming their lives and, by extension, our communities. Our vision positions YCCC as a catalyst for personal and community advancement, leveraging education as a tool for societal transformation.

Purpose: To create economic and civic prosperity in York County. We extend our educational impact beyond the classroom, aligning our programs with workforce needs and student aspirations, thereby fostering a thriving local economy and vibrant community life.

College Resources and Links

YCCC's Academic Affairs website contains information and resources for faculty, including policies and procedures.

<https://virtual.yccc.edu/academicaffairs>

The Center for Teaching Excellence (CTE) website includes information about Brightspace, instructional best practices, assessment design, grading guidance, instructor professional development opportunities, and more.

<https://virtual.yccc.edu/academicAffairs/TeachingExcellence>

Additional Links:

York County Community College:

[Homepage](#)

[Course Schedules](#)

Human Resources:

[YCCC HR Homepage](#)

[HR Employee Experience Page](#)

[MCCS HR Homepage](#)

[Annual Training](#)

[Annual Policy Notifications](#)

[HR Forms & Documents](#)

[Collective Bargaining Agreements](#)

Faculty Development and Services:

[Center for Teaching Excellence \(CTE\)](#)

[Library Services](#)

[MCCS Teaching and Learning Standards](#)

[ADA Faculty/Instructor Checklist](#)

[MCCS Policies](#)

Faculty Resources

Adjunct Faculty Workroom: The Adjunct Faculty Workroom is in the Center for Teaching Excellence (CTE) on the second floor of the Main Building on the Wells campus in Room 203.

This workspace provides you with access to computers, printers, basic office supplies, and space for meetings with students. It also houses the Center of Teaching Excellence which can provide instructors with support in Brightspace, instructional best practices, assessment design, grading guidance, and instructor professional development opportunities.

In-class Library Instruction: A YCCC Librarian is happy to visit your classroom and teach your students how to do academic research and to use citation style properly, either in person or online. Sessions typically last an hour and can be tailored to your specific class and assignment. Email Wendy West at wwest@maineccc.edu to schedule a class.

Research Instruction To-Go: Links to the YCCC Library's complete collection of online video tutorials, FAQs, printable handouts, and online assessment tools can be found at <http://virtual.yccc.edu/ToGo>.

If you are teaching online, the library has created the **Doing Library Research** module that can be embedded in your course. This content module includes video tutorials related to conducting academic research, creating citations, as well as checks for understanding. This module is available to students in the universal course shell.

Course Reserves: The library can provide students with access to supplemental course materials that are on Reserve in the Library. Email Wendy West at wwest@maineccc.edu for more information.

Getting Help: YCCC has an Online Help Desk to assist you with technical support. Email our IT team at IThelp@maineccc.edu for assistance.

Classroom and Instruction

Adjunct Faculty Responsibilities

Adjuncts are expected to be well informed with particular attention to the latest developments in their subject area and familiarity with our course delivery and classroom technology. Each adjunct will use the universal course shell and develop additional course content and appropriate instructional materials as determined by the department chair for their assigned classes.

1. Create a detailed course syllabus that follows the required syllabus template. The syllabus template is available on the [Center for Teaching Excellence website](#) in the Popular Links section.
2. Email a draft of your syllabus to your Department Chair for review one week prior to the start of the semester, submit a PDF of your final version to YCCCSyllabi@maineccc.edu by the first day of the semester, and upload your completed syllabus into the course shell in Brightspace to ensure your students have access on the first day of the class/term.
3. Design instructional materials and learning activities appropriate for the classroom or online environment. As you build the instructional materials and learning activities for your courses, please think about the varied learning styles of your students in addition to reinforcing life skills they will need well beyond YCCC (i.e., communication, collaboration, critical thinking, problem solving, data interpretation, and promoting an inclusive environment).
4. Check with your Department Chair if required materials or assessments must be incorporated into your courses. If the Department Chair indicates that there is an assessment that needs to be incorporated, do not change the assessment in any way. Use the title, description, and rubric provided to you.
5. Tracking student attendance weekly using the Qwickly tool in Brightspace is strongly encouraged.
6. Grade papers, projects, tests, and homework **with feedback** in a timely manner (within one week for semester-long courses) and enter grades in the Brightspace gradebook.
7. Communicate with your Department Chair about the instructional need(s) of the individual class to ensure quality of instruction.
8. Notify the department chair and the Dean of Education before an absence so arrangements can be made to cover the class assignment and/or notify students of a cancellation. Under no circumstances may an adjunct designate his or her own substitute.
9. Adjuncts cannot commit the college for any expense without written authorization of a campus administrator.
10. An adjunct instructor is responsible for providing course assessment data in accordance with assessment plans. Communicate with your Department Chair about any assessment expectations. Remember, do not change the assessment in any way. Use the title, description, and rubric provided to you.
11. Use the required textbook and instructional materials.
12. Adjunct instructors may not alter class schedules or locations. All courses must follow the start and end dates and times published in the [academic calendar and course schedule](#).
13. Provide students with a reasonable amount of assistance outside of scheduled class times.
14. Use the college's e-mail account to communicate with students, department chairpersons, and administration.

15. Complete all [mandatory trainings](#)
16. When feasible, attend and participate in college-wide workshops and departmental meetings.
17. Meet established deadlines and respond to administrative requests for syllabi, grades, contracts, personnel file information, etc.
18. All final grading must be completed and submitted by Wednesday after the end of the term/semester.
19. Respect each student's privacy rights related to his or her educational records including grades, attendance records, etc. In accordance with FERPA, you may not share student information, including with parents.
20. Accommodate students with disabilities according to the accommodation plan issued by the college. Following an accommodation plan is required by law.
21. Ensure all course materials are ADA compliant. The [ADA Faculty/Instructor Checklist](#) is available to guide instructors.
22. Comply with the standards, policies, and procedures of the college and the MCCC.

Classroom Use

If you are teaching a campus-based course, your course has been scheduled in a particular room for multiple reasons ranging from class size to availability. In addition to classes, YCCC also uses classrooms for meetings, interviews, conferences, workforce development training, and outside rentals. Because of this, it is important for all instructors to use only the space assigned to them.

As a courtesy to the next instructor, please clean the white boards before leaving the room. If you choose to use a laptop for your lecture, please ensure all computer and projector connections are re-established. Take leftover paper materials with you when you leave. Finally, please return the room to its original arrangement at the end of each class session if you choose to move the furniture.

Syllabi

Instructors must follow the approved YCCC course description, course learning objectives, and course outline for the course they are teaching. These are governed by the college and cannot be changed.

Sample syllabi for the course are available from your Department Chair or upon request from YCCCSyllabi@mainecc.edu. Instructors are required to use the most updated syllabus template to ensure all policies and procedures are up to date and that the syllabus is ADA compliant. The

syllabus template is available on the [Center for Teaching Excellence website](#) in the Popular Links section.

Syllabi must be provided to all students on the first day of class. Your expectations, grading policies, and all course requirements should be available in your syllabus and reviewed on the first day of class. A detailed syllabus helps to avoid confusion and misunderstandings during the semester, so the more specific the better. You should not include any policy that you are not willing to enforce.

Your syllabus and first-class meeting will set the tone and expectations for the semester. This information will help students decide whether to remain enrolled in your course during the add/drop period or if another class may be a better match.

Brightspace

Brightspace, the College's online learning management system (LMS), is available to all instructors teaching online or in the classroom. Online and hybrid instructors are required to use Brightspace for all course materials and assessments. On campus instructors should use their Brightspace companion course to include information that would be helpful to a student, like the syllabus or handouts, and grading. **Whether on campus or online, all instructors are required to use the syllabus feature to post the course syllabus and to use the Brightspace gradebook to record all grades. There are no exceptions to this requirement.**

Instructors who need to learn how to upload their course materials into Brightspace, use the gradebook, or have general questions are encouraged to attend a Brightspace training session or contact Center for Teaching Excellence for assistance at ycccCTEsupport@maineccc.edu.

Copyright Law and Fair Use

Fair Use: Fair Use is an exception in U.S. Copyright Law that allows, under certain conditions, free use of copyrighted works without the copyright owner's permission. Under this exception, a use is generally considered fair if it is beneficial to society without causing economic harm to the copyright owner. The distinction between fair use and infringement is not always clear or easily defined.

- There is no specific number of words, lines, or notes that may be taken safely without permission.
- Giving attribution to the source of the copyrighted material does not substitute for obtaining permission.
- And not all educational or non-profit uses are necessarily Fair Uses. Whether a particular use qualifies as fair use depends on all the circumstances in a specific case.

Learn more with this [short video tutorial](#).

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

The College provides accommodations for students with documented physical, learning, and/or psychological conditions, enabling them to have full access to academic and campus programs and services. The student is responsible for providing current documentation of the disability to the Accessibility Services Coordinator, Michele Osterhoudt, located in Room 205 of the Main Building. After a full and detailed review, reasonable accommodation(s) will be determined, and information provided through the student to the instructor. Students are taught to advocate for themselves; maximum student independence is a goal of this program.

If a student presents you with accommodations, please make any necessary adjustments to your course to ensure course materials are in ADA compliance. If you have questions or need assistance, please email Michele Osterhoudt at ycccaccessibilityservices@mainecc.edu.

If a student needs an appointment to request an accommodation, please send them to the Accessibility Services office in Room 205 and/or encourage them to email ycccaccessibilityservices@mainecc.edu.

FERPA Regulations

FERPA stands for the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act. This law protects the privacy of student education records. According to the US Department of Education, "FERPA gives parents certain rights with respect to their children's education records. These rights transfer to the student when they reach 18 or attend a school beyond the high school level. Students to whom the rights have transferred are 'eligible students.'"

To protect the privacy of an eligible student, the college must have written permission from the student to release educational records unless it is to a school official that has a legitimate need to know the information, such as an academic advisor. As instructors, it is important that we protect student information, including grades. Do not post grades in an area where other students will see them and always seek permission from the student before talking with a parent, spouse, friend, etc.

It is wise to always assume that *everyone* is FERPA-restricted. If anyone from the public (including parents and spouses) asks for student lists or student information, please reach out to Jessica Masi, Interim Associate Dean of Student Experience, at jmasi@mainecc.edu for guidance.

Instructor Absences/Lateness

Adjunct faculty members unable to attend a class must inform their Department Chair in advance. When possible, the Department Chair will arrange for coverage of class(es). If the absence is of an emergency nature, the faculty member must inform their Department Chair and the Dean of Education as soon as possible. Please contact the Dean of Education by telephone at 207-216-4476 or email acrampton@maineccc.edu. If you can, please email students and post an announcement on Brightspace.

If you will be late to class, please follow the notification process above. Students are not expected to wait beyond 15 minutes of the scheduled class start time for the instructor to arrive.

Evaluations

Teaching Observation: Adjunct faculty will be observed by their Department Chair and/or a college administrator at least once during their first year of teaching at the college, first year teaching in a new department, or as deemed appropriate by the Department Chair or Dean of Education. Adjunct faculty members can also request an in-class observation. Please contact your Department Chair if this is of interest to you. A summary of the evaluation will be prepared and shared with the instructor and reported to the Dean of Education along with the observer's recommendations. The form used for observations can be found on the [Center for Teaching Excellence website](#) in the Popular Links section.

Online Course Observation: Online courses must be designed and taught to align with the updated Maine Community College System Online Course Design and Teaching Standards. These standards can be found on the [Center for Teaching Excellence website](#) in the Popular Links section.

Online course design may be reviewed by the Department Chair or college administrator before the semester starts, and instruction will be reviewed at least once during the first year of teaching online.

End-of-semester student survey: Student feedback on courses, instructors, and college services is gathered at the end of each semester through an online survey. Students should be encouraged to complete their surveys.

Attendance and Grades

Mandatory Attendance/Participation Reporting

Class attendance is a key indicator of student success. While attendance is defined differently for online courses, the same holds true. For this reason, and to ensure the College meets the federal financial aid guidelines of disbursing funds only to students attending courses, tracking attendance is required.

Attendance in online courses is considered when students have participated through completing or submitting discussion posts, assignments, etc. Simply logging-in to the course does not count as attending.

Instructors are required to report attendance after the end of the add/drop period each semester. Please allow your class to meet at least once after the official drop deadline and then check the grade roster one more time. At this point you will be expected to formally report your attendance to the Registrar, Jess Masi. The Registrar will send instructions for reporting “no show” students via email. Instructors must meet the deadline indicated in the email.

Grade Reporting

Instructors are required to submit midterm and final letter grades according to the deadlines established by the College. Midterm grades are a way for students to assess where they stand in the class. The last attendance date must be reported when final grades are submitted for students who did not complete the course.

Grading System—Semester grades indicate levels of achievement and appear as letters with plus or minus options. Letter grades represent the following categories:

<i>Letter Grade</i>	<i>Grade Points</i>	<i>Grade Scale</i>
A	4.00	95-100
A-	3.67	90-94
B+	3.33	87-89
B	3.00	83-86
B-	2.67	80-82
C+	2.33	77-79
C	2.00	73-76

C-	1.67	70-72
D+	1.33	67-69
D	1.00	63-66
D-	0.67	60-62
F	0.00	Below 60
P (Pass) Used to signify that a student has successfully passed an “ungraded” course and may progress to the next course level. It is not calculated in grade point average (GPA), but credit hours may be applicable toward graduation requirements.		
AU (Audit) Utilized when a student is permitted to attend class for audit purposes only.		
W (Withdrawal) Assigned to students who officially withdraw from a course during the withdrawal period.		
AF (Administrative Failure) Assigned to students who stopped attending a course during the withdrawal period without officially dropping or withdrawing. The “AF” grade will hold the same grade points as an “F.”		

Incomplete Grade Policy

A grade of “I” (incomplete) may be awarded to a student after the withdrawal period under extreme circumstances that prevent the student from completing the coursework within the prescribed time period.

An Incomplete Grade Contract must be filled out by the instructor and student and approved by the Dean of Education before an incomplete grade can be assigned. Forms are available from the Dean of Education, Anne Crampton, at acrampton@maineccc.edu. The student cannot appeal this decision. The student must meet the following requirements: the student’s work to date is passing, the student has met the attendance requirements for the course prior to the event causing the request, and the student’s unfinished work can be completed within 30 calendar days from the last scheduled day of class for that semester. If the student fails to complete the work within the time period, the incomplete grade will automatically default to “F.”

Dealing with Academic Dishonesty and Plagiarism

The College promotes and maintains high ethical standards of academic conduct. For a student to get the most out of their education and to uphold the integrity of the degrees and certificates that the College awards, each instructor must also support, promote, and ensure academic integrity in the classroom. These resources will help you:

- [Procedure for Addressing Academic Dishonesty](#)
- Academic Dishonesty Report found in the MyYCCC portal

Student Success Commons

The Student Success Commons (SSC) at York County Community College provides a one-stop-shop for all academic support services for students, including:

- Free tutoring in writing for any subject, math, sciences, and more.
- Library resources and services
- Services for students with disabilities
- Student success coaches

The SSC also helps students adapt to the online learning environment and provides support for the academic adjustment to college. Support services staff can also help in areas like time management and organization as students navigate college demands.

Extensive resources may also be found at: <https://virtual.yccc.edu/studentsuccesscommons>

Library Resources

The YCCC Library webpage gives your students quick access to all the library's online resources, including Minerva (the Library Catalog), research databases, citation style tools, and online tutorials: <https://virtual.yccc.edu/library>. Some library resources are now available using single sign-on. Students and instructors can use their MaineCC credentials to access online library resources.

Human Resource Information

Annual Training

Per MCCC policy, all employees are required to undergo annual training which will be completed through Vector LMS Online Training System. Sexual Harassment, Diversity Awareness, and Campus SaVE Act are a few examples of classes that you may be required to complete. However,

you may be asked to complete additional training(s) required by OSHA depending on your content area. The expectation is that you complete this training before the first class of the semester.

Your required training(s) will be preloaded in the training system when you log in at: [YCCC Annual Training](#).

Username:

- **Hired prior to December 2024:**
 - YC + first initial of your first name + your last name
 - Example: **YCJDOE**
 - *(If ALL CAPS does not work, try all lowercase.)*
- **Hired on or after December 1, 2024:**
 - First initial of your first name + your last name
 - Example: **JDOE**
 - *(If ALL CAPS does not work, try all lowercase.)*

Contact Human Resources, at (207) 216-4444 or email the HR Director, Chris Heroux, at cheroux@mainecc.edu if you need further assistance.

Adjunct Availability Forms

Adjunct faculty members are responsible for completing [an availability form](#) for each semester that they are requesting a teaching assignment. Submission of the form does not constitute a guarantee or agreement that any course or time schedule will be offered or available. Deadlines for each semester are as follows:

- February 1 for the next fall semester
- February 1 for the next summer session
- October 1 for the next winter session
- October 1 for the next spring semester

YCCC's MaineCC Email Accounts (Outlook.com)

Each instructor will be issued a college email account. From within the email system, you will have access to all students, faculty, and staff, using name only. This MaineCC email address will serve as the official means of communicating with the college, so please check your email regularly for important announcements and communications.

YCCC manages email for all staff through Microsoft 365 and Outlook.com. You can log into your

email as a new instructor by going to the [Microsoft Outlook page](#) and using your MaineCC email address and YCCC-issued password. You will be prompted to change your password after your initial login.

Change of Personal Information

Employees are responsible for informing the college of a name change or change in address. This may be accomplished by logging onto Paycom and updating your information. Verification documents may be required for last name changes.

Tuition Waivers

Adjunct faculty members may enroll in one YCCC credit bearing course for each YCCC credit bearing course taught. The tuition waiver only applies to tuition—fees, books and other related expenses are the responsibility of the employee. Tuition waiver requests are granted at the discretion of the Academic Dean. Tuition waiver request forms are available on the Human Resources website.

Tobacco-Free Campus (Policy Y806)

YCCC is a tobacco-free campus. Smoking and use of all tobacco and vape products are prohibited on YCCC property, which means any land, building, or space owned or operated by YCCC, including vehicles owned or leased by YCCC. This policy applies to all students, employees, contractors, and visitors. It also includes organizers and attendees of any public events held at YCCC such as conferences, meetings, and performances.

Definitions and Clarifications:

- “Smoking and use of tobacco” is defined as the smoking or use of all tobacco products, including but not limited to, cigarettes, cigars, pipes, spit and smokeless tobacco, chew, snuff, “snus” and all nicotine delivery devices that are non-FDA approved as cessation products.
- “Vape products” are defined but not limited to nicotine and non-nicotine electronic cigarettes, personal vaporizers, or electronic nicotine delivery systems.

MCCS POLICIES

Access to the full-text version of all Maine Community College System (MCCS) policies is available via the System portal at [MyMCCS](#) by selecting MCCS Policies from the menu. The following pages represent Maine Community College System Policies that apply to all employees:

Section 201 Non-Discrimination, Equal Opportunity, and Affirmative Action

Section 202 Sexual Harassment, Sexual Assault and Consensual Relations

Section 407	Disability Accommodations in Employment
Section 410	Conflict of Interest
Section 416	Code of Ethics
Section 801	Safety in the Workplace and Learning Environment

Notice of Non-Discrimination

York County Community College does not discriminate as proscribed by federal and/or state law on the basis of race, color, religion, national origin, sex, sexual orientation, including gender identity or expression, age, genetic information, disability, marital, parental, or Vietnam era veteran status in specified programs and activities. Inquiries about the College's compliance with, and policies that prohibit discrimination on, these bases may be directed to:

Barbara Owen
112 College Drive, Wells, ME
Telephone: 207-216-4435
E-mail: bowen@mainecc.edu

The complete MCCS policy on Non-Discrimination, Equal Opportunity and Affirmative Action can be found on [MyMCCS](#).

Code of Ethics

The MCCS Board of Trustees believes there are certain core values that should guide all MCCS employees in their employment. To that end, the Board finds that it is important for all MCCS employees to:

1. Follow the highest standards of personal and professional integrity in all activities;
2. Strive to earn the respect and confidence of students, employees and the public;
3. Inspire trust in one's department, college and the MCCS;
4. Serve applicants, students, and other members of the public with courtesy and responsiveness;
5. Respect and protect all privileged information;
6. Stay informed of emerging trends, issues, and rules in one's area of responsibility;
7. Strive to provide the best and most cost-effective service to the citizens of Maine;
8. Approach all duties with a positive attitude and open communication;
9. Support the related efforts of other community colleges within the MCCS;
10. Comply with MCCS policies and Maine state laws governing conflicts of interest;
11. Handle fairly and efficiently issues of concern or dispute when they arise;

12. Embrace values of diversity and principles of non-discrimination and equal opportunity in all educational and employment activities.

